c. The Present Perfect Tense

Read the conversation between two friends and notice the use of the Present Perfect Tense.

A glutton

A: It is already half past nine. I need something to eat. **Have you had** your breakfast?

B: Yes, I **have had**.

A: What did you have?

B: I had only a dozen pooris and half a dozen omelettes.

A: Would you like to join me?

B: I don't mind. I ate an hour ago.

A: But there are only two pooris and one omelette left.

Do you eat as much as B eats for breakfast?

Always leave your stomach half filled. That's the best way to be healthy.

Form: Have/Has + past participle

Have/Has + Been + past participle

We use this tense

i) to denote something that has happened several times up to the present. e.g.: I have won the series twice so far.

ii) To announce a recent event or news. e.g. The Minister has announced a new scheme for the farmers.

iii) To refer to an action that has continued up to the present. e.g. I have known him since childhood.

'Since' or 'For'

We often use the Present Perfect with time expressions using **'since'** or **'for'**

Since is used when we refer to a point in time (in the past) until now.

For is used to refer to a period of time

Task: Which expressions go with 'since' and which go with 'for'? (Indicate with a tick. The first two have been done for you).

Since	For	
✓		last week
	✓	a short time
		a decade
		Pongal
		the day before yesterday
		6 months
		centuries
		June
		22nd June
		2009

d. The Present Perfect Continuous Tense

Listen to the cricket commentary of test match (Day 3, second innings) read by your teacher.

Mahendra Singh Dhoni ***has been batting*** since the first session of Day 1. He **has been contributing** to the score at a quick pace for the past ten overs. Kohli **has also been hitting** hard on the other side thrashing the opponents throughout the innings. They **have been running** quickly between the wickets since their partnership began.

The commentary given above is in the Present Perfect Continuous Tense. It is used to refer to an action / event that

Unit-2_021-050_Think globally - March-11-2018.indd 25 21-01-2019 10:27:21